CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 11: **Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which reading of 'many' is most reasonable? 1

(a) Nobel winners **(b)** her relatives only
(c) only sleeping people **(d)** people with sight who may lack insight

2. Choose the sentence that best uses 'inner power' as an abstract concept: 1

(a) An inner power bought a book. **(b)** Inner power helps us face failure.
(c) The inner power of the shop closed. **(d)** Inner power was switched on.

3. The phrase 'soul's own mastery' stresses 'own' to show: 1

(a) self-reliance **(b)** rivalry **(c)** loneliness **(d)** vanity

4. What does the poet gain by ending with 'inner power' instead of ending with 'Keller'? 1

(a) it sounds longer
(b) he avoids the title
(c) the universal message outweighs the person
(d) the poem rhymes

5. Which sentence is in the present perfect and shows lasting effect, like the poem's 'now ... receives'? 1

(a) She was inspiring. **(b)** She will inspire.
(c) She inspired millions in 1920. **(d)** She has inspired millions.

6. If the poem had said 'soul's mastery' without 'own', the effect would be: 1

(a) less stress on her self-effort **(b)** a plural
(c) a question **(d)** a rhyme change only

7. Which alternative title would best preserve the poem's central idea? 1

(a) Light from Within **(b)** A Dark Room
(c) The Great Traveller **(d)** Words and Music

8. The compound 'self-mastery' is formed from: 1

(a) self + master + y **(b)** self + mast
(c) se + lf **(d)** self + mastery

9. In the final stanza, 'dower' is used figuratively to mean: 1

(a) a prize she won **(b)** money she inherited
(c) inner qualities she gives to the world **(d)** a house she owned

10. A reader claims the poem is only for disabled people. Which argument best rebuts it? 1

(a) Keller was American
(b) Hughes wrote jazz
(c) the poem is short
(d) everyone faces some form of 'dark' and needs inner strength

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Assess the effect of the poem's silence about details of Keller's life. 2

12. Explain why the first two stanzas can be called a pair. 2

13. Why does the poet use 'now' in the last stanza? 2

14. Why is 'receives' a suitable verb for the last stanza? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Examine the logic of the three stanzas: why is the order important? 3

16. Explain how a reader's response to the poem may differ from a reader who has not read about Keller. 3

17. What does the poem suggest about the relationship between struggle and achievement? 3

OR

'The poem praises Keller but also instructs the reader.' Justify. 3

18. Rewrite as one complex sentence: 'Keller was blind and deaf. She mastered her soul. The world learns from her.' 3

OR

Discuss the universal appeal of the poem for students. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Argue for or against: 'This poem applies only to people with disabilities.' 5

OR

Write a speech on 'Inclusion and respect for the differently abled', quoting the poem briefly. 5

20. Write about a role model of your choice following the poem's structure (short lines, three stanzas). Add a note on why you chose that person. 5

OR

Evaluate the closing lines as a conclusion. How do they complete the poem? 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND